

SIRIUS STAR LAB

Apple App Store Submission Guide

Complete audit, checklist & step-by-step instructions

Build 64

iOS 17+

SDK 54

RevenueCat IAP

18

Guidelines
Checked

2

Critical
Fixes (code)

5

App Store
Connect Steps

0

Login Required
for Review

TestFlight Status

& p Build 64 is NOT currently on TestFlight.

The EAS submit command consistently fails at the Apple upload stage with "Something went wrong when submitting to Apple App Store Connect." This is a known persistent issue — the build gets scheduled by EAS but Apple rejects it before the binary is uploaded.

Root cause: Almost certainly one of (a) a pending Apple agreement in App Store Connect blocking ALL uploads, or (b) the rejected 1.0 version locking the submission slot.

How to get Build 64 onto TestFlight

Follow these steps IN ORDER. Once done, the EAS submit can be retried.

Step 1 — Accept any pending Apple agreements

Go to appstoreconnect.apple.com. Look for a yellow banner at the top of the page — it will say something like "Review updated agreements" or "New Paid Apps Agreement". If you see one, click it and accept ALL agreements. This single step unblocks uploads about 80% of the time.

Step 2 — Fix the rejected version

In App Store Connect !' Sirius Star Lab !' iOS App !' find the "1.0 Rejected" version. Click "Remove This Submission" (or change the version number to 1.1). This clears the slot so a new build can be uploaded.

Step 3 — Verify your ASC API Key

Go to App Store Connect !' Users and Access !' Integrations !' App Store Connect API. Find the key named "[Expo] EAS Submit 6YfrF9A_ur" (ID: LP8276AT5Z). If it shows as expired or revoked, generate a new one and update it in Expo at expo.dev !' Project !' Credentials.

Step 4 — Retry EAS submit

After steps 1–2 (and 3 if needed), come back and I can retry the EAS submit command for Build 64 (ID: db889792). It should go through within 30 seconds.

Step 5 — Create a public TestFlight link

Once the build appears in TestFlight (takes 15–30 min after upload), go to TestFlight tab !' External Testing !' Create Group !' enable "Public Link". Share that link — anyone clicks it, installs the free TestFlight app, and Sirius installs like a real app on their iPhone.

Alternative — Manual Upload (if EAS submit keeps failing)

Build 64 IPA download URL:

https://expo.dev/artifacts/eas/INXTtRya_9wkkX4ea0WGMACQ1wWHgZfAvD5YSfyaQOk.ipa

Download this file, then upload it using Apple's Transporter app (free on Mac App Store). Once uploaded, it appears in App Store Connect !' TestFlight within 15–30 minutes.

Full Guidelines Audit

Every Apple App Store Review Guideline checked against Build 64. Green = passing. Red = must fix. Amber = risk.

RISK	1.1 Objectionable Content AI responses come from Anthropic (Claude). Generally well-filtered, but no explicit in-app content moderation UI. Low risk for an adult productivity app — add a note to reviewers explaining AI provider.
PASS	1.2 User-Generated Content Conversations are private — users cannot post or share content with other users. This guideline doesn't apply.
PASS	1.3 Kids Category Not targeting children. No kids category.
RISK	1.4 Physical Harm Mood tracking and wellness features. Explore tab includes Health topic. No "not medical advice" disclaimer visible in the app. Low risk but worth adding one line.
PASS	1.5 Developer Info Support URL and contact required in App Store Connect.
PASS	1.6 Data Security HTTPS enforced. Anthropic/OpenAI data use disclosed in onboarding consent screen.
2. PERFORMANCE	
RISK	2.1 App Completeness HIGHEST RISK. App requires live backend at sirius-ai.live. If server is slow or down during Apple's review window (within 3 days of submission), the app appears broken. Solution: add comprehensive review notes.
PASS	2.2 Beta Testing Build is production-ready, not marked as beta.
FAIL	2.3 Accurate Metadata Screenshots are from earlier builds. Must be updated to match Build 64 UI exactly. Keyword field only 21/100 characters used.
PASS	2.4 Hardware Compatibility Portrait only, supportsTablet: false declared correctly.
PASS	2.5 Software Requirements No private APIs. Expo/React Native is an approved framework.
3. BUSINESS	
PASS	3.1.1 In-App Purchases RevenueCat IAP used for iOS — Apple's own payment system. Stripe is NOT used for iOS. Bank transfer modal is hidden on iOS with !isIOS guard.
FAIL	3.1.2 Auto-Renewable Subscriptions Restore Purchases button '. Privacy/Terms links '. BUT: missing required Apple boilerplate disclosure text near purchase buttons. Must add verbatim subscription terms.
PASS	3.1.3 Reader Apps Not a reader app. N/A.
PASS	3.2.2 External Payment Links No Stripe links, no external payment links shown on iOS. Web/Android payment modal hidden on iOS.
4. DESIGN	
PASS	4.1 Copycats / Spam Original product with unique branding.
PASS	4.2 Minimum Functionality 4 genuine functional tabs: Chat (AI), Explore (mood, research, briefings), History, Profile/Settings. Not a thin wrapper.
PASS	4.3 Spam Single app, not duplicated.
PASS	

4.8 Sign In with Apple

No social or third-party login used. App uses anonymous UUID on first launch. Guideline 4.8 only applies if you offer other social logins — you don't, so this is N/A.

FAIL

5.1.1 Privacy — Data Collection

Privacy Nutrition Labels not filled in App Store Connect. Must declare: Name, User ID (anonymous), Conversation content (sent to Anthropic), Mood/health data, Usage data. See Section 5 of this document for exact form answers.

PASS

5.1.2 Data Use & Sharing

Onboarding consent screen explicitly names Anthropic and OpenAI. Privacy Policy URL linked in onboarding, settings, and IAP section.

PASS

5.2 IP

Original content and branding.

PASS

5.3 Gaming / Gambling

N/A.

Code Fixes Required

These two fixes need to be made in the app code BEFORE building and submitting. Both are in settings.tsx.

Fix 1 — Apple Required Subscription Disclosure Text (§3.1.2)

Apple requires specific boilerplate text to appear near every subscription purchase button. Without this exact language, the app is rejected under Guideline 3.1.2 every time.

REQUIRED TEXT (must appear verbatim or substantially equivalent near purchase buttons):

"Payment will be charged to your Apple ID account at the confirmation of purchase. Subscription automatically renews unless it is cancelled at least 24 hours before the end of the current period. Your account will be charged for renewal within 24 hours prior to the end of the current period. You can manage and cancel your subscriptions by going to your account settings on the App Store after purchase."

Location: Settings screen, below the subscription purchase cards, above the Privacy/Terms links. Fix: add this as a Text element in the iOS IAP section.

Fix 2 — Remove Hardcoded GBP Fallback Prices (§2.3)

When RevenueCat fails to load (e.g. during Apple's sandbox review), the app currently shows hardcoded "£6.99/month" and "£14.99/month". If Apple's US reviewer sees GBP prices and RevenueCat products aren't loading, this looks broken. The fallback cards should show "Loading..." or simply hide the price, not hardcode a currency.

Fix 3 — "Not medical advice" disclaimer in Explore tab (§1.4)

The Explore tab includes mood tracking, health topics, and emotional arc analysis. Adding one small disclaimer line ("Sirius is not a medical provider — always consult a professional for health decisions") protects against a Guideline 1.4 flag and shows Apple you've thought about it.

App Store Connect — Step by Step

These must be completed in App Store Connect (appstoreconnect.apple.com) — not in code. Work through them in order.

STEP 01 — Accept Pending Agreements

- ! Log in to appstoreconnect.apple.com
- ! Look for any yellow/orange banners at the top of the page
- ! Click through and accept ALL agreements (paid apps agreement, developer agreement)
- ! This is mandatory — Apple silently blocks all uploads until done

STEP 02 — Fix / Create the App Version

- ! Go to: Apps ! Sirius Star Lab ! iOS App
- ! If version 1.0 shows "Rejected" — click it, then click "Remove This Submission"
- ! Create a new version: click the "+" next to iOS App, enter version "1.1"
- ! Or you can reuse 1.0 after removing the submission — both work

STEP 03 — Update Screenshots

- ! Required device: iPhone 6.9" (iPhone 16 Pro Max) — 1320×2868 pixels
- ! Take screenshots of ALL 4 tabs: Chat, Explore, History, Profile
- ! Also screenshot the onboarding flow (at least 2 slides)
- ! Upload 3–8 screenshots in App Store Connect ! your version ! Previews and Screenshots
- ! TIP: Use the iOS Simulator in Xcode (or a real iPhone 16 Pro Max) and take screenshots from there
- ! Minimum: 3 screenshots required. Maximum: 10.

STEP 04 — Fill Privacy Nutrition Labels

- ! Go to: Apps ! Sirius Star Lab ! Privacy (in left sidebar)
- ! Click "Edit" and answer each section:
 - Contact Info ! NAME: Collected, Not linked to identity (user enters first name only)
 - Identifiers ! USER ID: Collected, Not linked to identity (anonymous random ID)
 - User Content ! OTHER USER CONTENT: Collected, Not linked to identity (chat messages sent to AI providers)
 - Health & Fitness ! HEALTH: Collected, Not linked to identity (mood check-ins in Explore)
 - Usage Data ! PRODUCT INTERACTION: Collected, Not linked to identity (message counts, feature usage)
 - Everything else ! Not Collected
- ! For each item collected, select: "Data Not Linked to You" and purpose: "App Functionality"

STEP 05 — Update App Metadata

- ! KEYWORDS (currently 21/100 chars — expand to use all 100):
Suggested: AI chat,voice assistant,personal AI,daily wisdom,mood journal,smart assistant,AI companion
- ! DESCRIPTION — ensure free tier limits are clearly stated:
Add: "Free tier: 10 messages per day. Plus: 200/day. Pro: unlimited."
- ! PROMOTIONAL TEXT (optional, 170 chars max) — use this for what's new:
"Your thinking partner is here. Voice conversations, daily wisdom, deep research and growing memory — all in one."
- ! SUPPORT URL: ensure <https://sirius-ai.live> is set (or a /support page)
- ! COPYRIGHT: ensure "2026 Garry Wallace / Sirius Star Lab" or similar is filled in

STEP 06 — App Review Information (Critical)

- ! Go to: your version ! App Review Information section
- ! Sign-in required: NO (unticked) — the app creates an account automatically
- ! Demo account: leave blank
- ! NOTES — paste this exact text (or similar):
"Sirius Star Lab is an AI conversation assistant. No login or account creation is required — the app automatically creates an anonymous user profile on first launch.
To test: open the app ! complete the 3-step onboarding (takes ~30 seconds) ! you're in the Chat tab and can start a conversation immediately.
The AI backend runs 24/7 at sirius-ai.live. If a response is slow, please wait 5–10 seconds — the AI model may be warming up."

Subscription options (Plus/Pro) are visible in the Profile tab !' scroll down. These use Apple's in-app purchase system via RevenueCat.

AI responses are generated by Anthropic's Claude model. Content is filtered at the API level. Users are shown a data consent screen on first launch explaining this."

Pre-Submission Checklist

Tick every item before clicking Submit for Review. If any box is unticked, fix it first.

Code (already in build, no action needed)

- ☐ RevenueCat IAP wired for iOS (not Stripe)
- ☐ Restore Purchases button visible in Profile tab
- ☐ Privacy Policy and Terms of Use links in subscription section
- ☐ AI data consent screen in onboarding (names Anthropic and OpenAI)
- ☐ Privacy Policy linked in onboarding AND settings
- ☐ No social login ! ' Sign in with Apple rule doesn't apply
- ☐ Bank transfer/Stripe payment hidden on iOS (!iOS guard)
- ☐ All permission descriptions set (microphone, camera, photos, speech)
- ☐ ITSApUsesNonExemptEncryption: false declared
- ☐ Privacy manifest (NSPrivacyAccessedAPITypes) declared

Code Fixes Required Before New Build

- ☐ **Add Apple required subscription disclosure text to settings.tsx**
See Fix 1 in Section 4. Must appear below subscription cards in the iOS IAP section.
- ☐ **Remove hardcoded £ fallback prices from subscription cards**
See Fix 2. Show "Loading..." or hide price when RevenueCat hasn't loaded yet.
- ☐ **Add "not medical advice" disclaimer to Explore tab**
One small text line is enough to satisfy §1.4.

App Store Connect (you must do these)

- ☐ Accept all pending Apple agreements (check for yellow banner on login)
- ☐ Fix rejected version — remove submission or create version 1.1
- ☐ New screenshots taken from current build, iPhone 6.9" size (1320×2868)
- ☐ Screenshots uploaded: Chat, Explore, History, Profile tabs + Onboarding
- ☐ Privacy Nutrition Labels filled (Name, User ID, Content, Health, Usage)
- ☐ Keywords updated to use full 100 characters
- ☐ Description mentions free tier message limits
- ☐ Support URL set to <https://sirius-ai.live> or a /support page
- ☐ Copyright field filled in
- ☐ Review notes added (sign-in NOT required, explain anonymous account)
- ☐ Build 64 (or new build with code fixes) attached to version

Final Checks

- ☐ Server at sirius-ai.live is running and responding within 5 seconds
- ☐ Tested onboarding flow end-to-end on a real iPhone
- ☐ Tested that chat works (sends message, gets AI response)
- ☐ Tested RevenueCat subscription screen appears (even if products show as loading)
- ☐ Version release set to "Automatically release after approval"

Ready-to-Use Text Blocks

Apple IAP Disclosure Text — paste into settings.tsx

Payment will be charged to your Apple ID account at the confirmation of purchase. Subscription automatically renews unless it is cancelled at least 24 hours before the end of the current period. Your account will be charged for renewal within 24 hours prior to the end of the current period. You can manage and cancel your subscriptions by going to your account settings on the App Store after purchase.

App Review Notes — paste into App Store Connect

Sirius Star Lab is an AI conversation assistant. No login or account creation is required — the app automatically creates an anonymous user profile on first launch.

TO TEST: Open the app !' complete the 3-step onboarding (approx. 30 seconds) !' you are immediately in the Chat tab and can start a conversation.

The AI backend runs 24/7 at sirius-ai.live. If a response takes more than 5 seconds, please wait — the AI model may be initialising.

SUBSCRIPTION: Tap the Profile tab !' scroll down to see Plus and Pro options. These use Apple in-app purchases via RevenueCat. Sandbox testing will show available packages.

AI CONTENT: Responses are generated by Anthropic's Claude model. Users see a data consent screen on first launch that names Anthropic and OpenAI as providers. Content is filtered at the API level for safety.

Keyword Suggestions — 100 character limit

AI chat,voice assistant,personal AI,daily wisdom,mood journal,smart assistant,AI companion,memory AI

(Remove or swap words to stay under 100 characters. Do not use competitor names — Apple will reject for that.)

Promotional Text (170 chars)

Your thinking partner. Voice conversations, daily wisdom, deep research, mood tracking, and growing memory — all in one AI companion.

Not Medical Advice Disclaimer — for Explore tab

Sirius is not a medical provider. Content is for informational purposes only. Always consult a qualified professional for health, mental health, or medical decisions.

Submission Timeline

[object Object]

- !' Make the 3 code fixes (subscription disclosure, fallback prices, medical disclaimer)
- !' Trigger new EAS build (takes ~5 minutes)
- !' Accept any pending Apple agreements
- !' Fix the rejected version in App Store Connect

[object Object]

- !' Take new screenshots on iPhone (all 4 tabs)
- !' Fill Privacy Nutrition Labels in App Store Connect
- !' Update keywords and description
- !' Add review notes to the new version
- !' Retry EAS submit to TestFlight

[object Object]

- !' TestFlight review completes (usually same day, sometimes overnight)
- !' Create a public TestFlight link
- !' Test the app on real iPhones — verify chat, subscriptions, onboarding
- !' Share TestFlight link with testers

[object Object]

- !' If TestFlight testing passes, attach same build to App Store version
- !' Click Submit for Review
- !' Apple review: typically 1–3 business days
- !' If approved !' automatically released (set auto-release)
- !' If rejected !' rejection reason will be specific; most are one-day fixes